

TorqFall — Rulebook (Event #1, standalone)

Grade: Best · **Role:** TorqWars' first event — the whole day is TorqFall · **Basically:** Fall Guys with RC buggies

Rewritten 2026-09-06 to the locked standalone-event frame ([[2 - TorqFall (direction study v2 — standalone-event frame)]]): each game is its own event, TorqFall is event #1. This version folds in the non-elim qualifying → bracket → Tier-3 final structure and the Collapse Gate finish that the direction study and [[TorqFall — Level Directory v1]] ordered. The 2026-09-04 version's merged-day framing (Zone A/B, "runs alongside Sumo", a 5-rulebook shared day) is deleted — there are no zones, no parallel games, no shared day.

One gauntlet lane owns the floor all day. ~21 interchangeable rounds built from one modular kit, short heats, soft obstacles, near-instant reset — push the most people through the fewest cars, with overhead pile-ups as the content engine.

1. Objective

A pack of cars races down a chaos gauntlet of soft obstacles. **Survive and cross the finish** (or be first across, depending on mode). Wipe-outs, pile-ups, and last-second saves are the point.

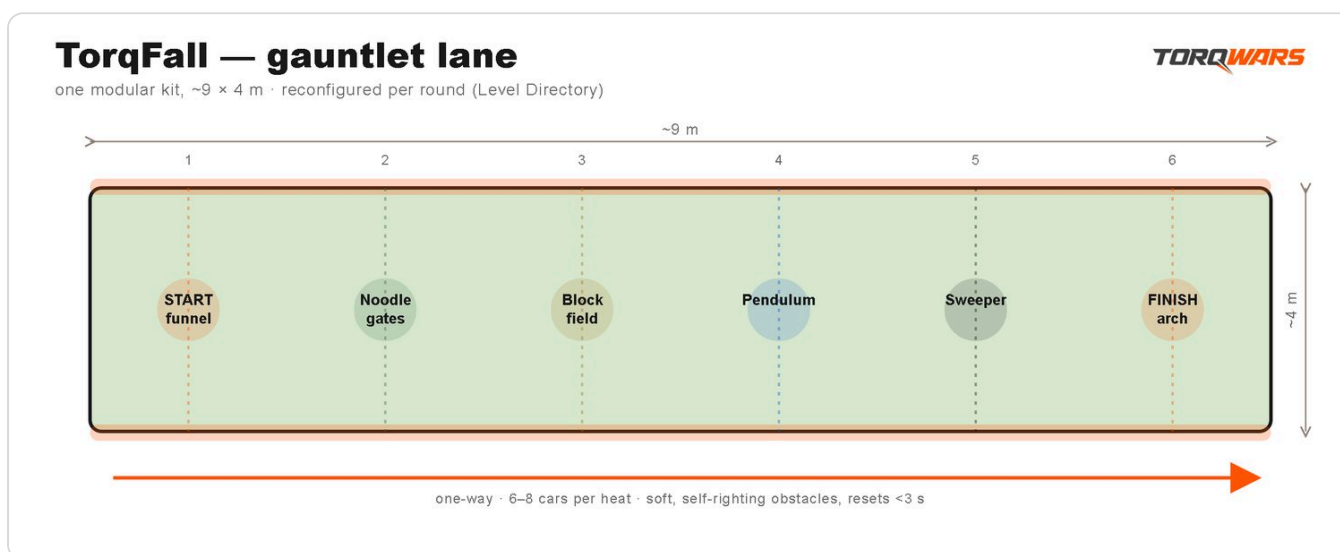
2. Format

- **Field:** 6–8 cars per heat (cap at what the lane width safely holds — see §3). Beginners crash constantly, so more cars = more chaos = more content, up to the point marshals can't reset.
- **Two modes:**
- **Race mode (qualifying default):** first car across the finish wins the heat; everyone else scores by finishing order — **nobody is "out."** Fast, simple, keeps the queue moving.
- **Survival mode (bracket + final):** obstacles run "live" (pendulum + sweepers active); a car knocked over or shoved out of the lane is **out**; last car moving OR first to finish wins. The Fall-Guys elimination feel — saved for when the day's stakes are up, never for a walk-in's first run.
- **Heat length:** ~60–90 seconds. If no one finishes in 90 s (everyone's wrecked), the car **furthest down the lane** wins.
- **Day structure — the tournament arc** (rounds pulled from [[TorqFall — Level Directory v1]]; rotate the shuffle every event so no two events repeat):

Block	Rounds	Mode	Elimination
Open qualifying (bulk of the day)	Tier-1 shuffle	Race	None — non-elim. Every driver gets N runs (default 3); points accumulate by finish position on the leaderboard. A paid ticket never ends in 60 seconds.
Bracket (afternoon)	Tier-2 shuffle	Race → survival	Top ~16 qualifiers seeded; heat winners advance.
Grand Final (the climax)	One Tier-3 round	Survival	The showpiece. Default finale: Collapse Gate — every survivor must punch through a breakable pre-scored wall to finish. The smash payoff for the whole room + the live collapse-mechanic field test that de-risks TorqSiege.

- **Between blocks:** free-play open laps — eliminated and waiting drivers keep driving while crew reconfigure the round. Nobody stands around.
- **Rotation:** wrecked-out drivers cycle to the back of the queue; winners may take one more heat then rotate. Keep fresh faces on camera.

3. The lane (the arena)



- **Lane:** linear gauntlet, ~9 × 4 m (~30 × 13 ft), flat turf, along a wall. One-way: **start gate** → **obstacle run** → **finish gate**. Tier-3 pen rounds (Hex-a-Fall, The Grinder, King of the Hill) run in a ~6 × 6 m pen **laid alongside the lane** at morning setup — the turf buy is sized for both (see [[TorqFall — What The Event Needs]] §2), so there is no mid-day re-lay.
- **Width discipline:** ~4 m holds 6–8 small cars abreast at the start, funnelling through obstacle pinch-points — the funnel *is* the chaos.
- **Soft side barriers** the full length (noodle-on-sandbag rail) so a shoved car bounces back in, not into a wall or the crowd.
- **Rounds, not one fixed layout:** the obstacle recipe changes per round — a **2–5 min crew layout change between blocks** (allowed because we own the floor all day; within a round nothing moves). All ~21 recipes live in the [[TorqFall — Level Directory v1]]. The signature **Full Gauntlet** order (Tier-3 #1): start funnel → noodle gates → foam block field → pendulum → sweeper → finish gate.

- **Design law:** every obstacle is **soft, self-righting or spring-back, and cannot trap or flip-launch a car**. No gaps, no drops, no rigid edges. A knocked obstacle must reset in **<3 seconds** within a round or it kills throughput.

4. Equipment

- **Cars: RENTED** speed-limited 1/16 stock buggies, rubber tyres — **12–16 per event** from the RC club partner: 6–8 live per heat + 4–6 on charge + 2 swap spares ([[TorqFall — What The Event Needs]] §1 prices the deal). **Nothing bolted, screwed or glued to a rented car** — foam bump-rings zip-tied on (come off clean), car ID by tape/velcro bibs.
- **Obstacle kit:** ONE modular DIY kit builds all ~21 rounds — noodle gates, EVA blocks, pendulum, 3 sweeper bars, spinner drives, ramp, tunnel kit, rollers, Collapse-Gate wall stock, lit arches. Full bill of materials + prices: **[[TorqFall — What The Event Needs]] §3** — the operative kit list. (*The old pointer to [[Build & Fabrication Plan v1]] is stale; the kit BOM no longer lives there.*)
- **Per heat:** 6–8 charged cars staged at the start; a return path (cars carried back up the side) so the next heat launches fast.

5. Match flow (marshal script)

1. **Stage:** 6–8 cars lined behind the start gate; drivers on the drivers' stand.
2. **Arm obstacles** (survival mode): pendulum cocked, sweeper running.
3. **Launch:** marshal countdown "3-2-1-GO"; pack charges the funnel.
4. **Run:** cars fight through the round's obstacle order. Marshal on the sweeper works it for maximum carnage-but-fair. A second marshal watches the finish + calls "outs."
5. **Out (survival mode):** flipped and can't self-right in 3 s, OR shoved fully out of the lane = **out**; marshal lifts that car clear so it doesn't block the lane.
6. **Finish:** first clean crossing (race) / last car moving (survival) = winner; marshal calls it to the screen. In qualifying the finish marshal also calls the finishing order for points.
7. **Reset:** marshals spring obstacles back, collect cars to the start, next heat in **~30–45 s**.

6. Scoring & fouls

- **Qualifying (non-elim):** points by finish position per run (e.g. 10-8-6-5-4-3-2-1); best N runs count; leaderboard on the screen. A bad run is a low score, never an exit.
- **Bracket / final:** heat winner advances; the final's survivor is the day's champion (trophy + podium — the closing reel shot).
- **Cutting the course** (skipping an obstacle by going around the barrier) = out of that heat / zero points for that run. Marshal's call, no review.
- **Ramming after you're out:** an out car must go still; a driver spoiling the heat gets skipped a turn.
- **No finish in 90 s:** furthest car down the lane wins.
- **Marshal is final** — throughput depends on fast calls, not fairness debates.

7. Safety

- Speed-limited cars only; a 6–8 car pack at low speed is safe, at full brushless speed is a demolition derby into the crowd barrier.
- Pendulum + sweeper are **foam only**, low mass, at car height — cannot hit a person hard; marshals keep hands clear of the sweeper motor.
- Soft side barriers full length; spectators behind them.
- Marshal calls "HOLD" to enter the lane (right a car / clear a jam); drivers ease off on "hold."

8. Content cues (the day's money shots)

- **Overhead cam locked on the lane** — the whole-pack pile-up at the first funnel and the sweeper wipe-out are the money frames.
- **Low finish-line cam** for the photo-finish / last-survivor limp across — and the Collapse-Gate wall burst in the final.
- **Onboard FPV** on 1–2 cars for the "first-person Fall Guys" POV.
- MC hypes the sweeper, the eliminations and the leaderboard race; cut every big wipe-out for reels.
- Capture: the mass funnel crash, a car surviving on its last wheels, the champion's wall-smash finish, a driver's reaction to getting swept at the line.

9. Round variety (was "variants")

The old pocket-variants graduated into the [[TorqFall — Level Directory v1]] as full rounds — Sudden-Death Sweeper is Tier-3 #7; Time Attack and Team Relay stay in the pocket as fillers when the queue is short. Programme variety by shuffling the directory (Tier-1 for qualifying, Tier-2 for the bracket, Tier-3 for the final), not by inventing on the day.

10. Reset/turnaround (for run-of-show)

- **Between heats:** spring obstacles back + collect cars + relaunch = **~30–45 s** — the throughput engine.
- **Between blocks:** a round swap is a **2–5 min crew layout change** (Level Directory law) — covered by free-play laps + the MC.
- **Within a round nothing changes;** the lane is built once on build morning and stands all day.
- Debris/tape check every ~30 min; swap a broken obstacle from the spare bin without stopping the lane long.

Pairs with: [[TorqFall — Level Directory v1]] (the 21-round library) · [[TorqFall — What The Event Needs]] (fleet, kit + the full costed needs list — its quantities derive from §2–§3 here) · [[Event Ops Standards (all games)]] · [[2 – TorqFall (direction study v2 — standalone-event frame)]] (why standalone). TorqBall and TorqSiege are their **own separate events** — nothing in this rulebook shares a day, a zone or a schedule with them.